

Time - Reading Clock Times

A Quick-Reference Guide

<u>AM, PM vs. "at night"</u>		<u>Exact Hours</u>
For adding "am," or "pm," generally only the numbers are read. e.g. 7:09am = seven oh nine am. e.g. 8:30pm = eight thirty pm or (but not both) To use other expressions you can add "at night," "in the morning," or "in the afternoon." e.g. It's eight thirty in the evening. [It's 8:30 pm in the evening.]		e.g. 7:00 = Seven = Seven o'clock = Seven sharp = Seven o'clock sharp = It's seven on the dot. = It's seven on the button.
<u>"15" /Quarter - Before</u>	<u>"15" /Quarter - After</u>	
Formula: (It's) (a) quarter of/to/till/until # e.g. 2:45 = Quarter of 3. = It's quarter to 3. = A quarter till 3. = A quarter until 3. = (It's) two forty five.	Formula: (It's) (a) quarter after/past # e.g. 3:15 = (It's)(a) Quarter past three = 3:15 = (It's)(a) Quarter after three = 3:15	
<u>< 30</u> For any number <u>less than</u> 30 Formula: (It's) # (minutes) past/after 3 e.g. 3:10 = It's ten past three. = It's ten after three.	<u>> 30</u> For any number <u>greater than</u> 30(min): Formula: (It's) # (minutes) of/to/till/until 3 e.g. 2:55 = 5 of 3 = It's 5 to 3 = It's 5 minutes till 3 = 5 until 3	<u>"0"</u> 3: 08 = Three oh eight. 5: 03 = Five oh three.
<u>= 30</u> #:30 (It's) <u>half past</u> #. (It's) # <u>thirty</u> . "It's half past ." "half past the hour." not "Half after" British: "It's half _#" e.g. 3:30 = (It's) <u>half past</u> 3 = (It's) three <u>thirty</u>	<u>Straight Style</u> - Only read the numbers. - Ok for any time. e.g. 4:15 = (it's/it is) four fifteen. e.g. 5:15 = (it's/it is) five twenty two.	<u>12 vs. 24</u> - The above phrases are only used for the 12 hour system. - For the 24 hour system, recommendation: use numbers only. e.g. "It's sixteen oh five." <u>USA:</u> Only the 12 hour system <u>Japan:</u> Both are ok. (12 or 24) <u>Europe:</u> Both are ok. (12 or 24) Special 24-hour pronunciation & notation: 0700 = "oh/zero seven hundred (hours)" 0000 = zero hundred hours (not 2400hours) 0318 = oh three eighteen hours (sometimes called "military time," e.g. US)